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UAE BOLSTERS LEADING HUMANITARIAN ROLE

This year has witnessed significant momentum in UAE humanitarian initiatives

ABU DHABI

The UAE marks World Humanitarian Day today, steadfast in its commitment to supporting humanitarian causes, safeguarding human dignity, upholding the right to a dignified life, and fulfilling its humanitarian responsibilities towards those affected by crises and disasters worldwide.

This year alone has witnessed significant momentum in UAE humanitarian initiatives and projects, reflecting the diversity and breadth of the country's humanitarian work.

The Edge of Life campaign has been among the UAE's most prominent humanitarian initiatives this year. Launched by His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, the campaign aims to save five million children from hunger worldwide. It raised more than Dh2.822 billion, with contributions from 44,208 individuals, companies and humanitarian organisations.

Relief for UAE, world

The Emirates Red Crescent (ERC), meanwhile, implemented relief programmes benefitting more than 1.5 million people in the UAE and 44 countries as part of its Ramadan programmes for 2026. Humanitarian initiatives also included projects supporting disadvantaged villages, providing essential services, and implementing health and social programmes in several countries.



The UAE supported those affected by the earthquake in the southern Philippines by distributing thousands of food parcels and supplies of potable water. It also allocated \$10 million to assist those affected by the earthquake in Venezuela and subsequently dispatched 70 tonnes of relief aid. In addition, the UAE announced

an urgent humanitarian response worth \$10 million to support those affected by the earthquake in Colombia.

The UAE has established an integrated model of humanitarian response for the Gaza Strip through Operation Gallant Knight 3, which marked 1,000 days of continuous humanitar-

ian operations this August. During this period, the UAE provided more than \$3.89 billion in humanitarian assistance, including over 126,000 tonnes of relief, medical and food aid delivered through more than 770 flights, 25 ships and over 13,000 trucks.

The UAE continued to provide various forms of humanitarian

support to the Sudanese people. Total assistance provided to Sudan over the past decade, from 2015 to 2025, amounted to approximately \$4.24 billion, while humanitarian assistance provided since the outbreak of the crisis in 2023 has exceeded \$800 million.

— WAM
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Trump rules out Iran talks as Hormuz deadlock deepens

UAE President, US leader discuss latest developments

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.

Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump said yesterday there were no talks with Iran under way or planned, hardening Washington's position as Tehran vowed to maintain its grip on shipping through the Strait of Hormuz until the United States meets its conditions.

The deepening deadlock came as UAE President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan received a phone call from Trump.

The two leaders discussed UAE-US cooperation and exchanged views on the latest developments in the Middle East and efforts to address them.

Phone alerts in UAE

The call came as the UAE briefly issued a phone alert warning of "potential missile threats", with the Ministry of Defence saying it had detected two ballistic missiles directed towards the country. UAE air defence systems responded, with authorities confirming that multiple threats were successfully intercepted.

● **Trump claimed the Strait of Hormuz was 'open and operating' and that all water mines had been removed or detonated.**

The Ministry of Defence said it remained fully prepared to respond to any threat and safeguard the UAE's sovereignty, security and stability.

Earlier in the day, Trump wrote on Truth Social, "There are no talks or conversations going on, or scheduled, with the Islamic Republic of Iran."

"The Naval Blockade remains in full force and effect," he added.

Trump claimed the Strait of Hormuz was "open and operating" and that all water mines had been removed or detonated. Trump also escalated his rhetoric over the strait, posting a map on Truth Social labelling Hormuz "NEW U.S. Territory".

He first floated the idea of declaring the strategic waterway US territory on Friday. Iran responded that the strait "will remain Iranian".

Iran, however, insisted it would not fully reopen the vi-

tal waterway, through which roughly a fifth of the world's traded oil passed before the war, until Washington honours what Tehran says are previous commitments.

Iranian parliament speaker Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf said those conditions included lifting the US blockade, releasing frozen Iranian assets, removing oil sanctions and ending military operations and threats.

"Until the United States fulfills its commitments ... the Strait of Hormuz will not reopen," he said.

Oman talks add pressure

With direct US-Iran negotiations stalled, Tehran has been holding separate talks with Oman on managing shipping through Hormuz and said Monday it was finalising details of a joint statement.

But tensions around Hormuz remained high. An unidentified projectile damaged a vessel's engine room off Oman and caused a crew casualty, according to the UK Maritime Trade Operations agency.

With Washington maintaining its blockade of Iranian shipping and Tehran refusing to restore normal passage through Hormuz, yesterday's statements left the two sides with no clear path back to negotiations.

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IN FOCUS



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Hope for Indian expats over airfare relief

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

India's Supreme Court has given the Centre three weeks to finalise draft rules regulating airfares, with the case set to return to court on September 7, a development the Indian expats in the UAE and Gulf have welcomed as hope for relief from soaring ticket prices to and from India.

The order on Monday came after judges reviewed the government's draft rules, submitted in a sealed envelope by Additional Solicitor General Anil Kaushik.

The case stems from a petition by activist S Laxminarayanan seeking an independent aviation regulator and clear guidelines against erratic fare hikes and extra charges by private carriers.

Major burden

The Pravasi Legal Cell (PLC), which has backed the case, said high fares, especially during peak seasons, festivals and emergencies, have long burdened low- and middle-income expats.

PLC Dubai president T.N. Krishnakumar and global president Jose Abraham, who is also a respondent in the case, described the issue as one of dignity and fairness, stressing that air travel is a lifeline, not a luxury, for millions of overseas Indians. PLC chapters in Oman and Kuwait echoed the call for reasonable, regulated fares.

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